

"We are scaling up in oncology through precision diagnosis, organ-specific programmes, and dedicated cancer management teams," says Dinesh Madhavan, President of Group Oncology & International, Apollo Hospitals.

Fortis is placing oncology at the core of its growth strategy, investing in advanced technologies and precision platforms. "Fortis has been channelling investments into technologies such as MR-Linac for adaptive radiotherapy, Gamma Knife Esprit for brain radiosurgery, and rapid genomic profiling to make treatments more targeted and efficient," says Dr. Ashutosh Raghuvanshi, MD & CEO, Fortis Healthcare.

The share of oncology revenues is likely to rise further for hospitals. Raghuvanshi says this reflects not only patient volumes but also the capital-intensive nature of oncology. Since cost is a big issue, Fortis is adopting a hub-and-spoke model to widen access to services. Centres in Tier II and III cities provide chemotherapy, immunotherapy, and diagnostic services, while hubs handle advanced procedures like radiosurgery, bone marrow transplants, and clinical trials. "We have expanded programmes in haematology and bone marrow transplantation and now plan to set up oncology and haematology centres of excellence, add services in cities such as Amritsar and Jaipur, and move into advanced areas such as immunotherapy and cell & gene therapies. Digital oncology and telemedicine are also on the horizon," says Raghuvanshi.

Aster DM Healthcare is following a similar model. Dr. Somashekhar S.P., Chairman of its Medical Advisory Board, says, "Cancer care contributes a steadily

growing share of revenues. Over the next three to five years, oncology will be among our main growth areas." The heavy capex means decisions to expand have to be taken with care. "Robotic and PET programmes typically reach break-even in 24–36 months. Proton therapy is considered over longer horizons," he says. "Public-private collaborations and mobile diagnostic units are used to keep expansion financially sustainable," he adds.

"All treatment—chemotherapy, surgery, radiation, bone marrow

real-world patient data." Affordability is built into its hub-and-spoke network. "Costs are reduced by 20–30%, and about 40% of our patients access therapies at affordable rates," says Mattoo. Future investments will focus on Tier II and III cities, molecular diagnostics, immunotherapy trials, and AI-enabled predictive diagnostics, he adds.

ONE DRUG AT A TIME

Pharmaceutical companies Sun Pharma, Dr. Reddy's, Cipla, Lupin, Biocon, and Zydus too are investing

CANCER CARE CONTRIBUTED 20% TO APOLLO'S REVENUE IN Q1 FY26. FOR MAX, THE NUMBER WAS 25%. FORTIS HEALTHCARE'S ONCOLOGY REVENUE IS 16% OF THE TOTAL

transplants, and immunotherapy—are seeing a rise in demand," says Dr. Mradul Kaushik, Senior Director, Operations and Planning, Max Hospitals. Oncology generates more than a quarter of Max's revenue. The group is investing in PET-CT, LINAC, and robotics. Its training institute supports more than 13,000 trainees annually.

HCG is continuing to focus almost entirely on oncology. "Our R&D and pipeline initiatives are directed at cancer care," says CEO Dr. Manish Mattoo. "We combine precision diagnostics, AI-driven planning, and next-generation therapies, integrating research with

across the cancer care spectrum, combining innovation, affordability, and access. The focus is on affordable biosimilars for costly biologics such as Trastuzumab and Bevacizumab. Beyond drugs, these companies are investing in diagnostics, personalised medicine, and collaborations, linking therapies to precision testing and clinical trials.

"Zydus invested 7–8% of FY25 consolidated revenue in R&D for new chemical entities, novel biologics, biosimilars, vaccines, complex generics, and medical technologies," says Dr. Sharvil Patel, Managing Director at Zydus Lifesciences. "The majority of our work in India